

Business meeting protocol

Chair: **Stacey Jeffery** Panellists: **Andris Ambainis**, **Min-Hsiu Hsieh**, **Eric Chitambar**

Transcribed by: **Jevgēnijs Vihrovs**

Date and time: July 6th, 2021, 14:00-15:00 UTC

Stacey Jeffery presents the agenda for the meeting.

Andris Ambainis presents the TQC 2021 Local organizing committee report.

Min-Hsiu Hsieh presents the TQC 2021 Program committee report.

Min-Hsiu Hsieh presents the Outstanding Paper Award to **Yassine Hamoudi** and **Frederic Magniez**, “Quantum Time-Space Tradeoff for Finding Multiple Collision Pairs”.

Eric Chitambar announces the TQC 2022 at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign. The dates for TQC 2022 are not yet known (a question by **Anne Broadbent**).

Stacey Jeffery describes how to submit proposals for TQC 2023.

Stacey Jeffery continues with the community discussions. The first topic: “The role of TQC vs. QIP”. What is the role of TQC in the field and how is it different from QIP? How much should the two conferences overlap?

Harold Nieuwboer asks what the plans for the online presence at conferences are moving forward. **Stacey Jeffery** suggests that being a hybrid conference could be one niche for TQC in contrast to QIP, however, it depends on the resources available to the organizers. **Sevag Gharibian** likes the hybrid conference, but not with the compressed talks; maybe an in-person conference with full talks and online viewing would be better. **Stacey Jeffery** likes the idea of people being able to participate in case they are not able to travel to the onsite venue. However, it also makes it easy for people to not attend, which removes an important aspect of the conference. **Māris Ozols** suggests it would be nice to keep the streaming option and upload the talks to YouTube. **Andris Ambainis** thinks it would be good to keep some online presence, but it should be something that should be left to the respective local organizers of the following conferences (to see whether they could organize a hybrid event). The question is how much effort and money such an option is going to cost. **Stacey Jeffery** suggests that the plans and possibilities for a hybrid conference could be discussed in the proposal for hosting TQC, however, it will not be a requirement. **Eric Chitambar** mentioned that streaming on YouTube now can be set up much easier than before, and they will try to do the streaming at TQC 2022. **Sevag Gharibian** notes that this might not be as easy for live talks.

Máté Farkas opens the discussion on the possibility of reaching out to the authors during the review process (if the reviewers have some doubts). Is this something that TQC might consider in the future to try to increase the transparency of the review process? **Stacey Jeffery** replies that this will be brought up to the Program committee, and it could improve the review process; of course, nobody claims that the PC does a perfect job, the review process will never be perfectly fair. The authors should continue to try to present their work as understandably as possible.

Stacey Jeffery continues with the TQC vs. QIP discussion. One difference is that TQC has proceedings, which is nice for a purely quantum conference, because it has the right audience for the paper. For other members of the community, the publication in the proceedings could preclude a publication in the journal, which is why TQC has two tracks: the workshop track with no proceedings and the conference track with proceedings.

Another difference is that TQC is “easier to get into to”, in contrast to QIP, because QIP is quite selective. There is room in the field to have two excellent quantum theory conferences. Still, there are some questions:

- (1) Should we implement restrictions on overlap between TQC and QIP?
- (2) Is there anything else we should do to distinguish TQC and QIP?

For (1), we would not want the same program happening twice. However, for example, we would not want to forbid a paper presented at QIP to be published in TQC proceedings (and, therefore, presented at TQC). We would also want QIP to accept a work presented at TQC, otherwise the submission numbers for TQC could get lower. If the overlap is small, it is ok to leave the situation as is. **Andris Ambainis** thinks that the overlap should come down naturally as the conferences come back to the onsite format. **Māris Ozols** points out that if QIP does not put restrictions on overlap with TQC, the number of submissions should not go down that much if TQC does. **Mischa Woods** says that we can also try to liaise with QIP organisers to find the overlap of participants, to see if it is high or not. Regarding (2), **Andris Ambainis** asks whether TQC could (or should) become an outlet for experimental quantum algorithms, which is an area not covered in both QIP and TQC. **Eric Chitambar** seconds on accepting more experimental papers. **Stacey Jeffery** makes a point that the Program committee is not currently specialized in such papers. **Māris Ozols** advocates for renaming TQC to QIP. **Michael Walter** does not think there is a pressing need to differentiate TQC from QIP: there are enough strong results each year to have two high quality “flagship” conferences (similarly as FOCS/STOC).

Māris Ozols returns to the discussion of the proceedings, and mentions some arguments against them:

- (1) Normally the paper is already on arXiv, so having it published in proceedings does not add much value.
- (2) It is extra work for the authors to shorten the paper for proceedings.
- (3) The review process at a conference is not as thorough, so in the end the quality of the proceedings’ version is up to the authors.

Stacey Jeffery says that it is traditional in TCS to publish in the proceedings and prefers to publish a quantum theory work in the TQC proceedings rather than participate in a general topic CS conference, where there the audience is not that generally interested in the quantum theory work. **Sevag Gharibian** mentions that departments use the proceedings in the publication count statistics, whereas arXiv does not count. **Stacey Jeffery** adds that not everyone has the time to publish in the journal at their career stage. **Andris Ambainis** thinks that it is good to have at least some substantial fraction of the top quantum theory papers published at one place. **Māris Ozols** would like proceedings more if they did not have a length restriction and perhaps had an extra (more thorough) round of review. Basically, if it was like a journal publication. **Stacey Jeffery** agrees that some papers stay published only in proceedings, and never go through a more thorough review (like for the journal publications). **Sevag Gharibian** thinks of proceedings length as a double-edged sword, since CS researchers often want to submit a complete version later to a journal, and this is often not possible if the proceedings have the full version already.

Finally, **Anonymous Attendee** asks whether there is any possibility to have “poster” sessions for talks like STOC 2021? **Andris Ambainis** says it is an unusual format, but this is an option to discuss. **Alexander Kliesch** notes that the last two years the Latvian team managed to make the event with no participation free. Is it possible, with the help of sponsors, to make TQC accessible to students from not-so-rich countries? Travelling and accommodation expenses can be challenging to a large part of the world. **Stacey Jeffery** thinks that it depends on the local organizers, but it is a good idea to have funding for students from the sponsorship. Moreover, if the conference is streamed, that opens a possibility for some form of a virtual event, which does not have a financial barrier for joining.

Stacey Jeffery thanks the Local organizing committee, the Program committee, the participants of the conference and ends the meeting.